INTRODUCTION

The presence of states with varying degrees of power makes it necessary to study the pattern of relationship among them. If one goes by the realist assumption, the international system is unrestrained and unprotected by any international government, where states have to look after their own national interests and, obviously, national security, thereby inducing insecurity in others. Therefore, the picture that emerges is one in which “each is against the other”. Though international relations may seem anarchic in the absence of any world government, yet it is not so in the sense of lawlessness and disorder.[1] The key to the puzzle, as the realists suggest, is the principle of balance of power which is “a basic principle of international relations and a fundamental law of politics as it is possible to find”. The political relations of independent nations, especially the great powers, traditionally have been explained by the theory of the balance of power.[2]